THE PORTRAIT OF THE BODY

AI + PERSONAL CHOICE

An amateur-tennis project combining sports footage, personal expression preferences and AI-assisted production to help players create videos with an individual character.

COLLEGE + INDUSTRY

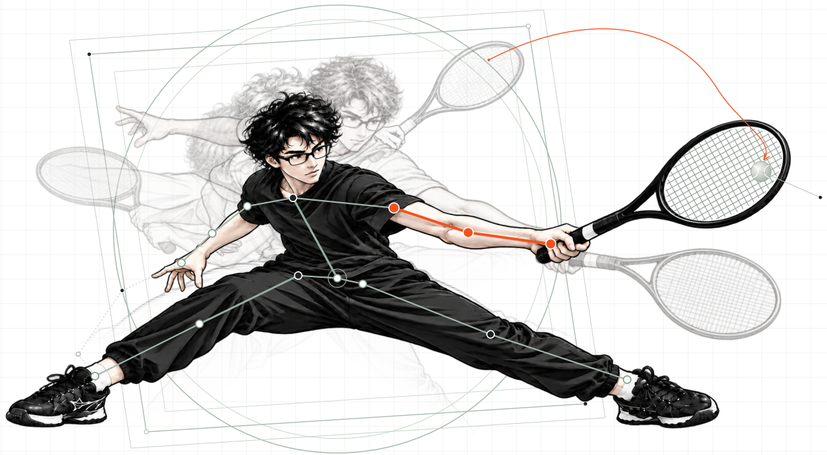
A three-person college project developed with Chengshi Sports (Alibaba).

MY CONTRIBUTION

Choice-system design; underlying technical implementation; exhibition and physical interaction; 16 double-sided portrait cards.

STARTING WITH FOUR PLAYERS

We interviewed four tennis players about recording, reviewing, editing and sharing - and the version of themselves they wanted their films to hold.



AI-ASSISTED CONCEPT ILLUSTRATION



FILM 01 / COMIC



FILM 05 / LYRICAL



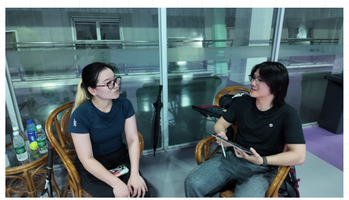
01 / KEEP A RECORD

Some mainly watch for themselves, valuing their sporting experiences and growth.



02 / EXPRESS A QUALITY

Some want to convey commitment, attitude and the uplifting state of playing sport.



03 / TAKE PART IN MAKING

Some judge highlights for themselves and enjoy choosing and editing.

Similar footage can carry different expectations. Body data describes an action; a player's account helps us understand what that action means to them.

Four in-depth interviews; themes grouped around recording purpose, expression and creative participation. Interview cards are summaries; source audio is linked.

01 / Giorgia Lupi - Data Humanism

Data Humanism connected data with personal experience and context.

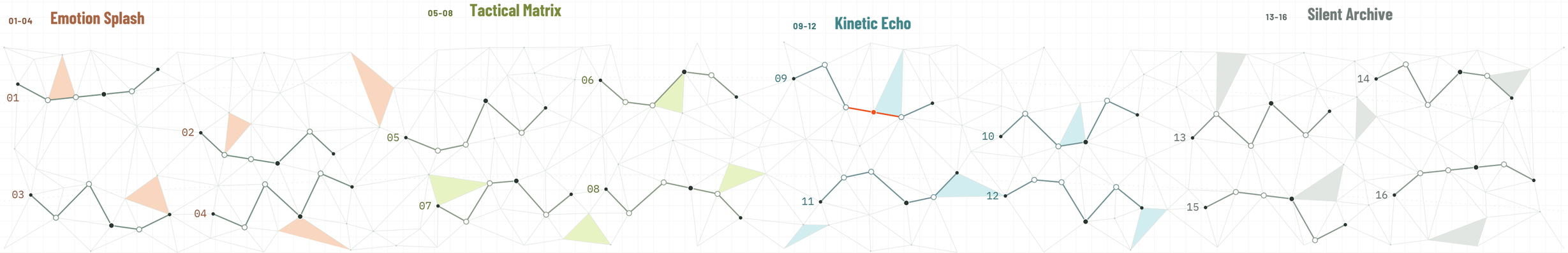
02 / Lin et al. - SportsBuddy, 2025

SportsBuddy informed the relationship between action information, visual cues and creative interaction in sports-video storytelling.

- A personal sports portrait begins with body information and the person's own ideas.

Personal intent becomes an input.

Four decisions describe an expressive direction; sixteen paths make the possibilities visible.



16 ORIGINAL PATHS / ONE CONTINUOUS CONSTELLATION

THE DESIGN TURN I INTRODUCED

The team initially aimed for fully automated production. I proposed that players' understanding of themselves - and the image they wanted to present - should also enter the generation process.

I designed a choice system that organised differences from the interviews into four dimensions. A few decisions describe the expressive direction someone wants this time.

FOUR EXPRESSION DIMENSIONS

Q1 / MOTIVATION

- For myself
- For social media

Q2 / FOCUS

- Technical parameters
- Emotional atmosphere

Q3 / DATA ATTITUDE

- Record + archive
- Aesthetic expression

Q4 / SOCIAL MODE

- Reserved / defensive
- Active connection

PORTRAITS GUIDE EXPRESSION

The team organised these tendencies into four main portraits, each with four variations: sixteen combinations. A result guides the portrait description, recommended effects and later style arrangement.

CREATIVE PARTICIPATION CONTINUES

These combinations begin a creative process. Users express a preference through choices and can still participate at the clip and narrative stages.

USER JOURNEY

Review footage → Set an intention → Choose + adjust → Keep or share

EXPRESSION WORKFLOW

Four choices → Expression portrait → Visual suggestions → Film arrangement

- Reduce the production burden while keeping personal intent active in the image.

AI makes the film. You shape its direction.

A role-based web prototype makes creative decisions visible, with motion analysis supporting the image.

POSE body **SCOUT** action **SELECT** moments **SCRIPT** tone **VFX** effects **EDIT** film

01 / AI DIRECTOR CREW

We designed an AI director-crew interaction prototype with six specialist roles: POSE, SCOUT, SELECT, SCRIPT, VFX and EDIT. They organise analysis, selection, narrative and production.

At key points, users can confirm the clips to retain, set an expressive tone, and continue participating or hand the next steps to the system. The roles make production easier to understand and give personal intent a clear place to enter.

01 / CHECK THE ANALYSIS

POSE + SCOUT

Production chat

POSE

33 body landmarks tracked.

SCOUT

Please review this reading.

Review / correct

Correct a reading

02 / KEEP THE MOMENTS

SELECT / HIGHLIGHTS

Which moments feel like you?

- [x] Forehand winner / 4s
- [x] Backhand passing / 3s
- [ ] Serve / 2s

Crew chooses | Use my picks

Keep what matters

03 / SET THE TONE

SCRIPT / EXPRESSION

What tone feels right?

Poised

Energetic

Playful

Skip | Confirm tone

Shape the voice

04 / CHOOSE THE AUDIENCE

EDIT / DELIVERY

Keep it your way.



Archive | Friends | Public

Save or share

WEB PROTOTYPE / ENGLISH REDRAW / EXAMPLE CONTENT

Footage + preferences > Action analysis > Clips + narrative > AI + coded effects > Composite output

02 / MY UNDERLYING MOTION ANALYSIS



AUTOMATIC CUTOUT



POSE EXTRACTION

My underlying implementation focused on action analysis and effect processing: body keypoints describe pose, person segmentation supports effects on the body, and motion events organise when effects appear.

Directly showing the skeleton could strip the image of the real body's texture. I moved it into the analysis layer and applied effects to actual people, strengthening movement while preserving the player's own appearance.

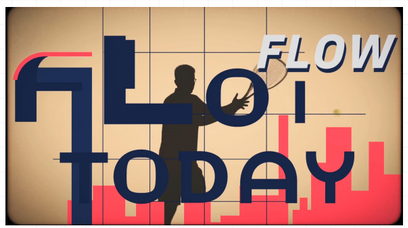
03 / FINISHED FILMS / USER-SELECTED FRAMES



COMIC / IMPACT PLAY FILM



COLOR / ENERGY PLAY FILM



TYPE / RHYTHM PLAY FILM

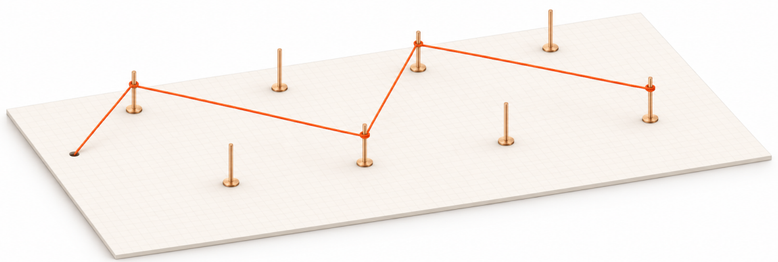
Prototype UI / implemented analysis. Technical studies and films are separate project examples.

- Action information shapes visual production; personal choices shape expressive direction.

Weave your portrait by hand.

Four choices become a thread pattern, a portrait card and a material preview.

01 WIND A PATH



AI-ASSISTED APPARATUS ILLUSTRATION / 1 START + 8 POSTS



ON-SITE WINDING

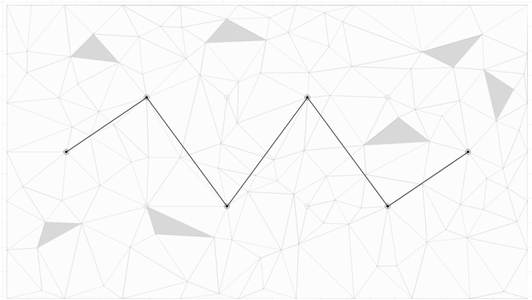
FOUR DECISIONS / ONE VISIBLE PATH

A thread emerges from one starting hole. Visitors make four decisions, choosing one post in each column of a two-row, four-column array: eight copper posts in total.

Four choices

Thread path

02 FIND A PORTRAIT



ORIGINAL CARD 13 / ONE OF 16 PATTERN FRONTS



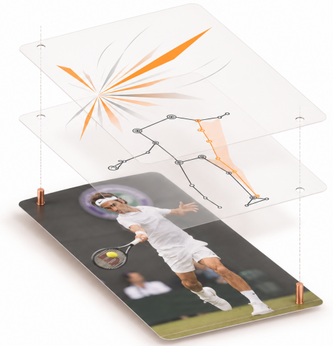
ON-SITE CARD READING

A POEM + VISUAL SUGGESTIONS

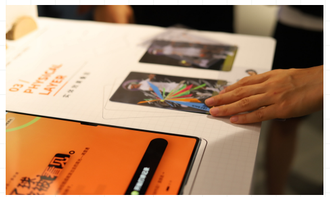
I designed sixteen double-sided cards. Each front matches a thread pattern; the reverse pairs a character poem with recommended visual effects.

Portrait card

03 LAYER A PREVIEW



AI-ASSISTED MATERIAL ILLUSTRATION / TWO REGISTRATION AXES



ON-SITE LAYERING

TWO POSTS / REPLACEABLE EFFECTS

Transparent effect cards fit over two copper posts at opposite corners of a fixed Federer photograph. Visitors stack and replace layers to preview different visual combinations.

Transparent layers

Visual preview

- Preferences become actions, paths and images that people can understand through making.

A portrait, brought into public.

An exhibition that visitors could understand, choose, try and watch.

MY EXHIBITION WORK

I was responsible for the exhibition and interaction apparatus, bringing research panels, the film screen, winding area and portrait cards together as one stand. Visitors could understand the theme, choose, try and watch.

DESIGNING A PARTICIPATION SEQUENCE

01 **READ**
Find the project question.

02 **CHOOSE**
Wind a path; find a portrait.

03 **TRY**
Compare transparent effects.

04 **WATCH**
See the film possibilities.

EXHIBITION LOGIC / ACTIONS IN SEQUENCE



LIVE EXPLANATION

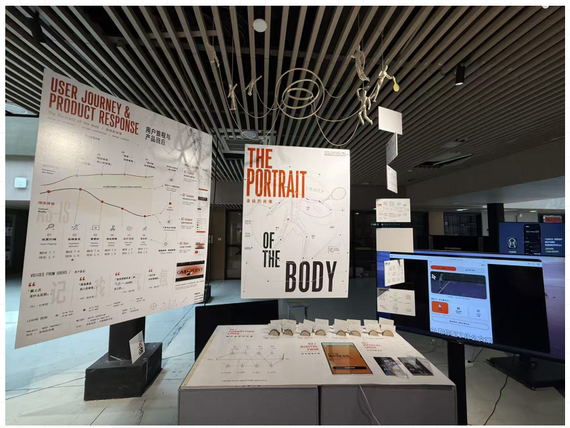


COURSE EXHIBITION / GROUP PHOTOGRAPH

I helped bring personal ideas into generation, implemented underlying techniques and turned the choice system into a participatory physical experience.

This clarified my design interest: connecting personal expression, AI-assisted creation and interaction so technology responds to a particular person.

The project received the course collaboration's sole Best Award and recognition from Chengshi Sports.



FULL STAND / HANGING MODELS + TABLE

White surfaces, orange headings and black type extended the project's visual language. Hanging body models, lines and cards echoed the thread paths on the table, connecting the body, its traces and personal expression in one space.

Visitors could wind threads, find cards, stack transparent layers and watch the films. Five demonstration videos explored different directions, including live action, body contours and comic treatments.

5 film demonstrations / interaction prototype / physical apparatus / exhibition

- Connect personal expression, AI-assisted creation and interaction around a particular person.